

STORYBEAT — FULL USER EXPERIENCE WALKTHROUGH

0. App Launch (First-Time User)

User Action

- Taps the StoryBeat app icon on their phone.

App Behavior

- Launch screen with:
 - StoryBeat logo
 - Tagline:
“If you can tell us 12 things, you have a story. If you can’t, we’ll help.”
- Subtle motion (not flashy).
- No login gate **yet** (or optional “Continue as Guest”).

First-Time Setup (One Screen, Optional)

- Toggle:
 - ✨ “I want to move fast” (default ON)
 - 🧠 “I want more control” (can be adjusted later)
- This silently biases AI behavior but does **not** block flow.

User taps Start a Story.

1. Project Creation: The First Question

Screen: “What’s your story about?”

Minimal, focused UI:

- One large text field
- Placeholder text:

“A sentence or two is enough. Don’t overthink it.”

Examples beneath (tap to autofill):

- “A burned-out detective hunts a killer who might be his future self.”
- “A teenage witch accidentally traps her town in a time loop.”
- “A man loses his dog... and discovers it was abducted by aliens.”

User Action

- Types 1–3 sentences.
- Taps **Continue**.

(If user types too little: gentle nudge — not a block.)

2. Framing Prompt (Optional, Fast)

Screen: “Do you want to frame this story?”

Two large buttons:

-  Add an Opening Frame
-  **Skip for now** (default emphasis)

If user taps Add Opening Frame:

- Options appear:
 - Prologue
 - Cold Open
 - Flash Forward
 - In Media Res
 - Surprise Me

If user skips:

- No friction. Flow continues.

(Same logic will apply later for Closing Frame.)

3. The Core Loop Begins: Beat 1

Screen: Timeline View (Collapsed)

The user now sees the **Timeline Stack**:

Beat 1 — Where We Begin
Beat 2 — What They Want
Beat 3 — The World Around Them
...
Beat 12 — How It All Ends

Only **Beat 1** is expanded.

4. Beat Interaction Pattern (This Is the Heart of the App)

Beat 1: Where We Begin

Expanded card shows:

- Beat title
- Prompt text:
“Where does the story start? Who is this person before everything changes?”

Buttons:

-  Write It
-  Surprise Me
-  Skip for Now

Option A: **User Writes**

- User types a sentence or paragraph.
- Taps **Accept**.

Result:

- Beat text is saved.
- Beat is unlocked by default.
- App auto-scrolls to Beat 2.

Option B: **Surprise Me**

- AI generates **3–5 options**, each a short paragraph.
- Each option has:
 - Accept
 - Try Again

User selects one → auto-accepted.

Option C: Skip

- Beat card collapses.
- Beat marked as *Incomplete*.
- Flow continues anyway.

(*Speed > completeness.*)

5. Progressing Through the 12 Beats

This exact interaction pattern repeats for:

1. Where We Begin
2. What They Want
3. The World Around Them
4. Something Goes Wrong
5. A Hard Choice
6. Crossing the Line
7. Things Get Messy
8. A Truth Is Revealed
9. Everything Starts to Fall Apart
10. The Lowest Point
11. Becoming Someone New
12. How It All Ends

Key UX Rules During This Phase

- User can:
 - Jump ahead to any beat
 - Go back at any time
 - Edit anything
- AI:
 - Fills gaps when user skips
 - Infers connective tissue
 - Warns but never blocks
- Canon:
 - Nothing is locked unless user locks it

- AI suggestions are provisional until accepted

6. Locking (Optional, Never Required)

On any beat, user can tap:

-  **Lock**

Result:

- Beat becomes canon.
- AI can reference it but never alter it.
- If future beats conflict, the app warns — it does not stop.

Locking is presented as:

“Lock this if you’re sure. You can unlock later.”

7. Branching (Advanced but Discoverable)

At any beat:

- User taps Fork from here

Result:

- App creates a **new timeline**:
 - Inherits everything up to that beat
 - Everything after is empty
- Timeline selector appears:
 - Main Timeline
 - Fork from Beat 7

User can switch freely.

(This does NOT interrupt the main flow. It’s additive.)

8. AI Gap Detection (Non-Blocking)

At certain moments (mid-outline or near completion):

Subtle banner appears:

“We’re missing one detail that could help this story land. Want to define it?”

Buttons:

- Define Now
- Surprise Me
- Ignore for Now

User choice determines depth — never blocks completion.

9. Closing Frame Prompt

Once Beat 12 exists (written, AI-generated, or skipped):

Prompt appears:

“Want to add a Closing Frame?”

Options:

- Epilogue
- Final Image
- One Year Later
- Surprise Me
- Skip

Same behavior as Opening Frame.

10. Completion Moment: The Outline Is Done

Screen: Full Timeline View (Expanded)

User now sees:

Beat 1 — Where We Begin
✓ *Summary*

Beat 2 — What They Want
✓ *Summary*

...

Beat 12 — How It All Ends
✓ *Summary*

Visual indicator:

 **12-BEAT STORY OUTLINE COMPLETE**

No judgment. No “score.”
Just completion.

11. Pitch Mode

CTA appears:

Create a Pitch

User taps.

Pitch Generation Screen:

Options:

-  Logline
-  Short Synopsis
-  One-Page Pitch

Defaults:

- All selected.

User taps Generate Pitch.

AI Behavior:

- Uses:
 - Canon skeleton
 - Final beat summaries
 - Frames (if present)
- Generates clean, professional output.

12. Pitch Review & Export

User sees:

- Logline (editable)
- Synopsis (editable)
- One-pager (scrollable)

Actions:

-  Edit
-  Regenerate section
-  Export (PDF / Text)
-  Share (read-only or editable)

13. Aftermath: Retention Hook

Final screen:

“Want to try another version?”

Options:

- Fork a timeline
- Rewrite a beat
- Start a new story

The user is never told they’re “done.”

They’re invited to explore — but the outline already exists.